

Ilayda B. Onder

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Academic Appointments

Assistant Professor of Political Science, Texas A&M University 2024 – Present

Education

Ph.D. in Political Science, The Pennsylvania State University 2024
Fields: International Relations, Political Methodology
M.A. in International Relations, Koc University 2018
B.A. in International Relations, Koc University 2016

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

10. Berlin, Mark, **Ilayda B. Onder**, and Joshua Fawcett Weiner. 2026. “Leadership Succession and Jihadist Beheadings.” *Journal of Global Security Studies*. Accepted.
9. Berlin, Mark, and **Ilayda B. Onder**. 2026. “Beyond Outbidding: Armed Group Responses to Transnational Jihadist Competition.” *Journal of Conflict Resolution*. Accepted.
8. **Onder, Ilayda B.** 2026. “A Principal-Agent Theory and Network Analysis of High-End Cooperation Among Militant Groups.” *Political Science Research and Methods*. Accepted.
7. Amjad, Maria, Mark Berlin, Sara Daub, **Ilayda B. Onder**, and Joshua Fawcett Weiner. 2026. “Commanders of the Mujahideen: Introducing the Jihadist Leaders Dataset.” *Journal of Peace Research* 63(2): 289–297.
6. **Onder, Ilayda B.**, and Mark Berlin. 2025. “We Have Nothing to Do with It: How Statements of Denial by Armed Actors Shape Public Perceptions and Emotions.” *Political Psychology*.
5. **Onder, Ilayda B.**, Nazli Avdan, and Aaron M. Hoffman. 2025. “Credit Claims and the Survival Rates of Terrorist Organizations.” *International Interactions* 51(6): 1050–1066.

4. **Onder, Ilayda B.** 2025. "How Civilian Loyalties Shape Rebel-led Victimization of Rebel Constituencies." *Journal of Conflict Resolution* 69(4): 701–730.
3. Loyle, Cyanne E., and **Ilayda B. Onder.** 2024. "The Legacies of Rebel Rule in Southeast Turkey." *Comparative Political Studies* 57(11): 1771–1803.
2. **Onder, Ilayda B.** 2024. "Target Hardening and Non-State Armed Groups' Target Selection: Evidence from India." *Terrorism and Political Violence* 36(8): 1105–1126.
1. **Onder, Ilayda B.** 2023. "Signaling Resolve through Credit-claiming." *International Interactions* 49(5): 755–784.

Research in Progress

*Indicates graduate student co-author. **Indicates undergraduate student co-author.

Revise & Resubmit

3. Performative Rebel Governance and Legibility: Evidence from Rebel Recruitment in Southeast Turkey. R&R, *American Political Science Review*.
2. Introducing the Rebel Internal Governance Dataset (with Hongbi Choi*). R&R, *International Studies Quarterly*.
1. Quantitative Premises and Challenges in Studying the Kurdish Conflict in Turkey. R&R, *PS: Political Science & Politics*.

Under Review/Submitted

2. Accessing the Elites: Rebel Wartime Lobbying in the U.S. (with Yu Bin Kim)
1. Populism and Counterterrorism Preferences: The Roles of Strongman Rule, Outgroup Attitudes, and Conspiratorial Thinking. (with James Piazza)

In Progress

12. When Constituencies Unite but Recruitment Competition Divides: Cooperation and Infighting Among Armed Groups. *Draft in progress*.
11. Inter-Group Learning and Diffusion in Militant Alliances. *Draft in progress*.
10. Civilian Victimization by Governance-Oriented Rebels. (with Hongbi Choi*) *Draft in progress*.
9. Rebel Recruitment under State Repression. (with Muge Acarlar*) *Draft in progress*.
8. Rhetorical and Behavioral Compliance with International Humanitarian Law by Rebel Groups. (with Merve Keskin, Yu Bin Kim, and Blair Welsh) *Draft in progress*.

7. Rebel Territorial Control, Tax Evasion, and Kidnapping. (with Mark Berlin and Tim Jones) *Data analysis in progress.*
6. Leadership Succession and Social Service Provision in Rebel Groups. (with Joshua Fawcett Weiner and Mark Berlin) *Data analysis in progress.*
5. Rebel Service Provision and Foreign Public Opinion. (with Yu Bin Kim and Gidong Kim) *Data analysis in progress.*
4. Rebel Internal Governance and Foreign Public Opinion. (with Hongbi Choi*) *Data collection in progress.*
3. Denial and Rebuttal in Rebellion. (with Mark Berlin and Kate Willey**) *Data collection in progress.*
2. Inter-Group Mobility in Conflict. (with Finn Klebe) *Data collection in progress.*
1. Part-Time Rebels. *Design stage.*

Grants, Fellowships, and Awards

Texas A&M University

Bush School Seed Grant Program, \$11,990	2025
Glasscock Faculty Research Fellowship, \$5,000	2025
Scowcroft Faculty Research Grant Award, \$2,400	2025

Centre for the Comparative Study of Civil War, University of York

Civil War Paths Fellow	2024
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USIP-Minerva Research Initiative

Minerva Peace and Security Scholar Fellow, \$20,000	2023-2024
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The Pennsylvania State University

Lombra Outstanding Graduate Research Award, \$1,000	2024
Summer Graduate Research Award, \$16,000	2020–2023
Outstanding Political Science Graduate Student, \$1,500	2022
RGSO Dissertation Support, \$2,000	2021
Program in Empirical International Relations Fellowship	2021

Teaching

Texas A&M University

Introduction to Political Science Research (Undergraduate)	Fall 2024, Fall 2025
Ethnic Conflict (Undergraduate)	Spring 2026
Conflict Studies (Graduate)	Fall 2026
<i>Ph.D. Advisory and Dissertation Committees:</i> Hongbi Choi; Muge Acarlar; Julia Reyes; Santiago Vidal Calvo; Nathaniel Williams	

The Pennsylvania State University

International Relations Theory (Undergraduate)	Spring 2024
Quantitative Political Analysis (Undergraduate)	Fall 2023

Conference, Workshop, and Colloquium Presentations

American Political Science Association	2023, 2024
International Studies Association	2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026
Junior Scholars in Quantitative Conflict Workshop	2023
Midwest Political Science Association	2019, 2023
NYU-CESs Experimental Political Science Conference	2024
Online Peace Science Colloquium	2021
Peace Science Society (International)	2020, 2021, 2023, 2025
Political Networks Online Colloquium	2023
Texas Triangle IR Conference	2025, 2026

Invited Talks and Workshops

<i>The Clash of Methods in Studying Ethnic Conflict</i> Peace Science Conference, University of Central Florida	November 2025
<i>New Frontiers in Research on Terrorism and Civil Wars</i> University of Houston	March 2025
<i>Rising Scholars Workshop</i> Peace Science Conference, Washington University St. Louis	November 2023

Datasets

Jihadist Leaders Dataset (JLD) (with Maria Amjad, Mark Berlin, Sara Daub, and Joshua Fawcett Weiner)

Data on 31 biographical attributes of 238 leaders from 110 jihadist groups across Africa, Asia, and the Middle East between 1976 and 2023, drawing on Arabic, English, French, German, Turkish, and Urdu sources.

Northeast Indian Militant Group Networks Dataset

Network dataset of 53 ethnonationalist militant groups active in Northeast India from 1981 through 2021, coding 8 forms of cooperation: joint operations, training, arms and funds, intelligence-sharing and logistical support, joint planning and meetings, joint public statements, umbrella organizations, and rhetorical support.

Civilian Victimization in the Kurdish Insurgency Dataset

572 incidents of the PKK's coercive acts, targeting or unintentionally harming civilian bystanders in 21 provinces in southeastern Turkey with significant Kurdish-speaking populations between 2014-2019, recording the characteristics of individuals (e.g., public worker, politician, alleged state informant, business owner).

Rebel Internal Governance (RIG) Dataset

(In development)

Time-variant data on 14 internal institutions and practices of 166 rebel groups across 57 countries between 1990 and 2012, capturing both written and de facto regulatory frameworks, judicial procedures, and disciplinary practices used to regulate fighter behavior.

Denial and Rebuttal in Rebellion Dataset (with Mark Berlin)

(In development)

Data public statements issued by rebel groups in the sub-Saharan African, Middle East and North Africa, in which they refute allegations (e.g., affiliations with other non-state actors, the arrests of their members, the killings of their leaders, involvement in criminal activities) made by governments or media outlets.

Service

Departmental Service

Graduate & Curriculum Committee, Texas A&M University	2024–Present
Advisory Committee, Penn State University	2023–2024
Graduate Student Association of Political Science, Penn State University	2019–2022

Chair/Discussant

American Political Science Association	2023
International Studies Association	2025, 2026
Texas Triangle IR Conference	2026

Workshop Organizer

Junior Scholars in Quantitative Conflict Workshop	2024–Present
Junior Scholars in International Security Workshop	2023–2024

Reviewer

American Journal of Political Science, American Political Science Review, Comparative Political Studies, Conflict Management and Peace Science, Global Change, Peace & Security, International Interactions, International Studies Quarterly, Journal of Conflict Resolution, Journal of Global Security Studies, Journal of Peace Research, Journal of Politics, Network Science, Palgrave Macmillan, Political Science Research and Methods, Security Studies.

Professional Associations

American Political Science Association
International Studies Association
Peace Science Society (International)

Last updated: May 1, 2026